

TARAZUG

Stars: White Dwarf

Known for: Tarazug's Disease, The Empty Portal, The Omran Stone Ruins

Exports: -

Imports: -

The Tarazug system is home to only a handful of planets. Except for the portal station and a few researchers, courageous entrepreneurs and daring explorers, the system is largely ignored. On the planet Tarazug, there is still one last colony of the first settlers called Al'amal, who have vehemently refused to leave the planet to this day. Tarazug may be the system with the least permanent residents - even less than Odacon.

In addition to the two portals to Odacon and Zib, there is a third portal, but it leads to an unknown location. It is generally assumed that this portal only leads into the void.

ANCIENT RUINS AND THE PLAGUE

In addition to the colony, the neighbouring planet Omran contains the remains of an ancient culture. Scientists are unsure whether these are the ruins of portal builders or the settlement of another - or perhaps even much older - culture that has since disappeared. This would at least support the theory about the Tarazug plague, according to which the systems were colonised long ago, but then collapsed due to this highly infectious disease. Scientists could not find the reason, the disease is inactive in

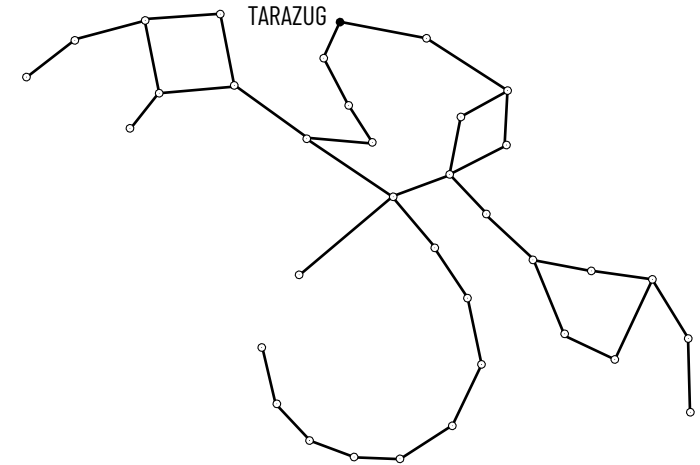
all other systems. And the few colonists here receive regular injections to prevent an outbreak.

THE EMPTY PORTAL

Externally, it is similar to every other portal in the 3rd Horizon. It has the same fields and appears to function normally when flying through it, with no noticeable differences from other portals. The only difference is that no ship that has ever travelled through the portal has ever returned. The last attempt to explore the portal was made 35 years ago, shortly after the Second Portal War, by a fleet of twelve ships led by a temple ship of the Order of the Pariah. When this expedition failed to return, the portal was officially declared empty, and the prevailing opinion among researchers is that the portal builders have not yet created a corresponding counterpart for this connection. The use of the portal is not officially prohibited, but the portal station in the Tarazug system strongly advises against attempting the journey.

PLANETS

The planet Tarazug offers slightly better living conditions than Omran and is still inhabited by early settlers today, but most of the old cities on the planet are abandoned and in a state of increasing decay. Between the former settlements of the first settlers, the wide valleys with their high mountains and the extensive lakes surrounded by huge forests, there are also remnants of an ancient



culture on Tarazug, albeit significantly fewer. In fact, only one ancient settlement has been found so far that bears similarities to the stone ruins on Omran.

The last remaining human settlement on Tarazug is Al'amal - a former metropolis of which only two districts are still in use. Barely more than 9,000 settlers live there. However, due to the plague, the number is decreasing from cycle to cycle, and hardly anyone from the Horizon wants to live on the planet unless they are forced to.

